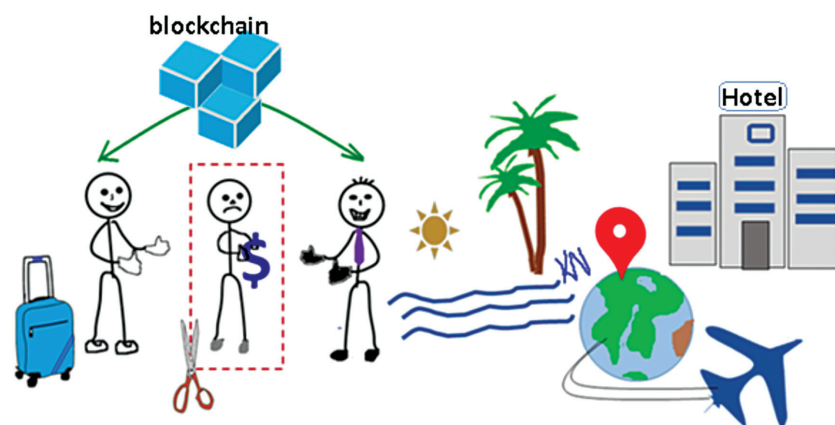


How Blockchain is Transforming the Travel and Hospitality Industry

Blockchain is proving its potential in and changing the travel industry's status quo by playing a major role in keeping the network secure, protected, and trusted. Hundreds of blockchain developers are working in India.



The offerings of artificial intelligence (AI) keep breaking news due to their capabilities and AI being the forerunner of most big commercial opportunities. Blockchain is another technology that claims many surprising benefits and hence is spoken of non-stop by engineers and customers. These two advanced technologies support and draw benefits from each other. Together, these two innovative technologies, AI and blockchain, endorse the data provided to them and find the outcome which, when used for mass-market, changes the way trust, security, and responsibility are perceived, hence adding economic value to the businesses.

Blockchain became popular when entrepreneurs realised that it facilitated business transactions at a significantly lower cost, giving them more control and independence. It is noteworthy that a business can grow exponentially with the combination of AI and

blockchain as they work wonders for the organisation and the customers. The application of blockchain in sectors like banking and healthcare promises a better future, and the tourism industry is no exception.

In 2018, the revenue through the aerospace industry was US\$ 838 billion. This industry is already using promising technologies like artificial intelligence and 3D printing to improve operations. But due to the B2B intermediaries, customers need to pay a high price. So, the industry should also consider use of blockchain.

The tourism sector has started using blockchain to change the way its data is stored, used, and secured. The sector expects blockchain to reshape the industry through transparent and secured transactions without the involvement of any third party between the hosts and guests, digital travel ledgers, faster identity management of customers, and much more.

A report published by SITA (Société Internationale de Télécommunications Aéronautiques) declares that by the end of 2021, 59 percent of airlines would have initiated implementation of blockchain in their working.

Blockchain and cryptocurrency

Blockchain is a distributed, decentralised data structure that serves as a proof of work for the occurrence of events in a specific order. This digital ledger is immutable and stores the encrypted data. For example, when a transaction is made online, that event is represented as a block and is broadcast to peer-to-peer (P2P) network (computers/nodes).

The mechanism employs an encryption method known as cryptography, which uses known algorithms to validate the transaction and user's status. The verified transaction can involve cryptocurrency, contracts, records, or other information. The transaction is combined with other transactions for verification. Then a new block of data is created for the ledger. The new block is added to the existing, permanent, and unalterable blockchain, and there is no way of erasing any data. The transaction is now finished without the involvement of any bank. Each transaction in the form of a block is time stamped, to pin the event to the real time, and many such blocks are linked together forming a chain, hence the name blockchain. These chains